Going beyond laptop specs

Why Asus is focusing more on colour and design

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Ever since the first laptop went on sale, people have bought laptops while trying to make sense of lots of numbers. Buyers have compared processors, RAM, storage, display and graphics before making a decision – we've all been there. But this way of buying laptops, which involves purely analysing a lot of numbers, is getting out of fashion fast, according to Asus. With its latest Vivobook lineup, the company is putting more emphasis than ever on colour, design, and cutting-edge AI capabilities beyond just bumping up hardware specs.

In an exclusive conversation, Arnold Su, Vice President of Consumer and Gaming PC at the System Business Group at Asus India, spoke about why colour is becoming an important part of laptop buying decisions, where Vivobook sits alongside ROG and ProArt, how AI is changing PCs, and how rising RAM and SSD prices are forcing manufacturers to rethink laptop configs.

Asus' increased focus on colour across all laptop tiers

The PC industry has traditionally been obsessed with incremental spec bumps, but Asus is pushing a broader lifestyle focus across its entire lineup rather than keeping distinct colours confined to only entry-level laptops models.

"For this launch, we want to see how we can combine technology with lifestyle," Su said. "As a company, we keep talking about technology and bringing the latest tech to the market... We were very tech-savvy. Recently, we've realized that while many customers want the latest tech, there are also many who need a decent machine but care more about the product's style."



Arnold Su
Vice President of Consumer and Gaming PC at the System Business Group at Asus India

"Earlier, multi-colour options were confined to mainstream or entry-level models in our Vivobook series," Su explained. "Now, we want to take it a step further: multi-colour shouldn't just be in mainstream Vivobook, but also on the Vivobook S and even Zenbook lineups."

Su recalled an interaction with a senior from his college who was looking for a laptop for office use. Despite having a good budget, her only real requirement was that the laptop should be pink. The experience, Su told, made him realise that many consumers care less about specific hardware and more about the laptop's appearance, colour and feel. Just like a smartphone, a laptop is also increasingly becoming a lifestyle choice.

Addressing whether offering bold colours risks making a laptop feel less premium, Su pointed out that adding variety doesn't mean compromising on performance. He said,"We still ensure top-tier performance, CPUs, RAM, SSDs, thermal designs, and form factors. We are simply adding another flavour."

"In recent years, the PC industry hasn't had much excitement beyond repetitive CPU and GPU spec bumps. We wanted to offer something fresh outside of just spec updates", Su added.

Where Vivobook fits alongside Asus' ROG and ProArt series

With ROG dedicated to gaming and ProArt tailored for high-end creators, Asus balances its specialized brands against the broader consumer audience of Vivobook through trickle-down technology.

"Internally, I have had a lot of debate with the BU team about this," Su admitted. "As a technology-leading company, our headquarters' concept is that any new technology must first have a unique position, like ProArt. That is a very specific, refined product for high-end content creators who require premium technology and high standards. But the key decision point is how we gradually bring that similar technology down to the mainstream and entry levels."

Su highlighted Asus' history in gaming as the blueprint for creator tech: "We started 20 years ago with only ROG, which was super-premium and expensive. Later on, within ROG, we segregated it into ROG Strix for maximum performance, then Strix G for mainstream gaming, then TUF about 7 to 8 years ago, and even Vivobook Gaming around 3 to 4 years ago. ProArt is currently in a very unique segment, but we are observing the market to see how we can bring down that unique creator experience into various price tiers within Vivobook over time."